

HTTP vs HTTPS: The Simple Difference Explained

HTTP (HyperText Transfer Protocol) :

- **No encryption** – The data is sent as plain, readable text (anyone can see it).
- **Uses port 80** – This is just the "door number" HTTP uses to connect to websites.
- **Not safe from hackers** – Hackers can spy on or change your data while it's traveling.
- **No certificate needed** – It doesn't need any special security certificate to work.
- **A bit faster, but risky** – It works slightly quicker since there's no locking/unlocking of data, but it can't guarantee your data stays safe or unchanged

HTTPS (HTTP Secure) :

- **Data is locked (encrypted)** – Before sending, the data is scrambled using SSL/TLS so no one else can read it.
- **Uses port 443** – This is the special "door number" HTTPS uses to connect safely.
- **Keeps data safe and unchanged** – No one can spy on it or secretly alter it while it's traveling.
- **Needs a security certificate** – A trusted company (Certificate Authority) gives the website this certificate to prove it's safe.
- **Shows a lock icon + better for Google ranking** – Browsers show a  padlock for HTTPS sites, and Google ranks these sites higher in search results.